STUDENT CASE INSTRUCTIONS

Using a Sandboxed Ticketing Website to Teach Digital Trust and IT Audit

Read the SeatGate case before beginning the activity. You are a junior IT auditor at Rogers & Rogers LLP evaluating whether SeatGate's stated control policies are enforced by system behavior and supported by audit evidence. Document your procedures, observations, findings, and recommendations in the worksheet assigned by your instructor.

Two student templates are provided in the `worksheets` folder:

- worksheet-version-1.docx: the standard worksheet, with COBIT 2019 questions, website transaction discovery, automation observations, policy evaluation, and internal-control review.
- worksheet-version-2.docx: the shorter alternative implementation worksheet, with transaction discovery, a process narrative, automation observations, internal-control review, and debrief questions.

Complete only the version assigned by your instructor. Follow your instructor's directions for individual or group work and for submitting the completed worksheet. The two versions use the same SeatGate system and classroom evidence, but differ in the amount of written documentation.

Before the Activity

Use the SeatGate website and student account provided by your instructor. Sign in with your assigned username and password. You do not need to create a GitHub account or set up Render to participate in the classroom activity.

For the standard implementation, read Section 1.1.1, "What Is COBIT and What Is It Not?", in *COBIT 2019 Framework: Governance and Management Objectives*, available from ISACA at https://www.isaca.org/store2/product/CB19FGMP-C. Your instructor may also assign this reading with the shorter alternative worksheet.

Review the six stated policies in the case. Your objective is to determine whether each policy is supported by the system's behavior and the available evidence. Do not assume that a purchase satisfies a control policy simply because the system records it.

Activity Flow for Both Versions

1. **Trial event and website inspection.** Log in, view the trial event, submit a purchase request, and observe the confirmation or error message. Inspect the website and consider what each page area does and why it matters for internal control.
2. **Main ticket drop.** When the instructor releases the tickets, attempt to purchase tickets and document the results. The activity may be competitive or noncompetitive. Follow your instructor's directions and the stated rules.
3. **Controlled automation demonstration.** Observe the instructor's controlled five-ticket purchase. Compare the automated process with your manual purchasing experience. Review

the accompanying pseudocode and the effects on the purchasing account's ticket holdings, sales totals, and remaining inventory.

4. **Backend evidence review.** Review the records supplied by the instructor. These may include transaction logs, failed purchase attempts, exception reports, user activity, ticket holdings, wallet balances, or other evidence relevant to the control review. Compare the system records with your observations and SeatGate's stated policies.

5. **Internal-control review and debrief.** Identify weaknesses, explain their risks, and recommend preventive or detective controls. Be prepared to discuss one observed weakness, the evidence supporting it, and your recommendation.

If your instructor assigns the optional AI-assisted coding extension, use and test only instructor-approved code within the SeatGate sandbox. Your instructor may introduce this extension during the trial event. Record what the code attempted, how the system responded, and what evidence supports your conclusion.

Use your assigned student account to test the student purchase policy. The instructor's admin account is privileged, so a successful admin purchase alone does not establish that the same request would be accepted from a student account.

Standard Implementation Student Template Version 1

Complete the following sections in worksheet-version-1.docx:

1. **COBIT 2019 Framework Questions.** Answer the two questions about what COBIT is, how it can help an auditor evaluate SeatGate, and one thing that COBIT is not.

2. **Website Transaction Discovery and Short Process Narrative.** Record what you observed on the home, login, user account, and cart pages. Complete the short narrative explaining where the process begins, what the system does next, and when the purchase is completed.

3. **Controlled Automation Observation.** Explain what the script attempted and whether the system blocked or limited the automated behavior. Base your response on the demonstration and any assigned coding extension.

4. **Policy Evaluation.** Evaluate all six stated policies. Record whether each policy is working and support your conclusion with an observed weakness or other audit evidence.

5. **Internal-Control Review.** Identify control weaknesses and the associated risks. For each weakness, record a relevant COBIT 2019 objective or practice using its code and name, recommend a control, and identify the control type.

6. **Class Discussion Questions.** Explain the most important weakness revealed by the exercise and the evidence an IT auditor would need to determine whether the stated policies were enforced.

Alternative Implementation Student Template Version 2

Complete the five numbered sections in worksheet-version-2.docx:

1. **Website Transaction Discovery.** Record how many tickets you purchased, the event or events, and what you observed on the home, login, and user account pages.
2. **Short Process Narrative.** Explain where the process begins, what the system does next, and when a purchase is completed.
3. **Controlled Automation Observation.** Explain what the script attempted and whether the system blocked it. If your instructor assigned the AI-assisted testing extension, explain what AI generated and what you still needed to understand yourself. Otherwise, write "not used" for that question.
4. **Internal-Control Review.** Identify control weaknesses, explain their risks, recommend controls, and identify the control type. Include the relevant COBIT 2019 objective or practice with each observed weakness.
5. **Class Debrief Questions.** Explain the most important weakness and the evidence needed to evaluate the stated policies. Be prepared to connect your observations to authorization, inventory, logging, exception reporting, and management review.

Your instructor may add the COBIT framework questions or the six-policy evaluation from the case to extend this shorter implementation. Complete these additional tasks only if assigned.

Student Deliverables

Submit the completed worksheet assigned by your instructor, with the supporting evidence requested for your classroom run. Evidence may include screenshots, transaction results, inventory changes, ticket holdings, or log entries. Clearly connect each finding and recommendation to the evidence supporting it. A separate audit memo is required only if assigned by your instructor.

Repository and Video Resources

The case repository is available at https://github.com/ais-2026-anonymous/ticketing-system. It provides the website source code, instructional videos, and additional classroom resources. Use the portions of the Classroom Briefing Video assigned by your instructor. The Observing Network Flow Video shows how the browser's Network panel can be used to inspect the request generated by a purchase.

Scope of the Exercise

Complete this case only within the SeatGate sandbox and within the scope authorized by your instructor. Do not apply these techniques to real ticketing websites or other external systems without explicit authorization from the system owner. The purpose of the exercise is to understand IT audit, internal controls, transaction processing, and audit evidence in a controlled classroom environment.